FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, TOWEL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers towel clamp forceps, of Backhaus and Roeder designs, for affixing towels to skin surface during surgical procedures.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and sizes.*—The towel forceps shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.1) :

Type I. — Backhaus design.
Size 1. — 3½ Inch.
Size 2. — 5¼ Inch.
Type II. — Roeder design.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

GG-I-526 — Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 — Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 — Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-12902 — Packaging of Surgical Dental and Veterinary Instruments Diagnostic Equipment, and Related Items.

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. — The following document forms a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

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Steel Products Manual, Stainless and Heat Resisting Steels.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Iron and Steel Institute, 150 East 42nd Street, New York 17, New York.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Material.**—The towel forceps shall be fabricated of class 2, composition K steel, conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification GG–I–526 or of American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI) 410 stainless steel, both meeting the hardness and corrosion tests requirements for class 2, composition K steel, as specified in Federal Specification GG–I–526.

3.2 **Style, design, and dimensions.**—Shall be towel clamp forceps, suitable for affixing towels to skin surface during surgical procedures, and shall be as hereinafter specified.

3.2.1 *Type I (Backhaus).* — Type I shall be of the Backhaus design, size 1 or 2 as specified in the procurement document, and shall be in accordance with figure 1.

3.2.2 *Type II (Roeder).* — Type II shall be of the Roeder design, with ball stops, and shall be in accordance with figure 2.

3.3 **Locks.**—Locks shall be box lock type in accordance with the requirements of Federal Specification GG–I–526.

3.4 **Finish.** — Finish shall be mirror or mirror and satin in accordance with the requirements of Federal Specification GG–I–526.

3.5 **Additional requirements.** — Except as specified herein, the towel clamp forceps shall comply with applicable requirements and tests of Federal Specification GG–I–526. The requirements of that specification for micrometallographic examination shall not apply.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **Supplier responsibilities for inspection.** —The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, auditory, etc., investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2 *Certificates of quality.* — When available, certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, listing the specified test method and test results obtained, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor.

4.2 **Sampling.**

4.2.1 *For examination.* — Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.2.2 *For tests.* — Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105. Requirements applicable to individual unit only (see table I).

4.2.3 *Raw materials.* — Four ounces of each lot of metal used in the construction of the forceps shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.2.4 Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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TABLE I.

Component	Characteristic	Req.	Test procedure	Unit of product	Insp. level	AQL
Forceps	Hardness	GG–I–526	GG–I–526	1-forceps	L3*	**
	Copper sulfate	GG–I–526	GG–I–526	1-forceps	L3*	**
	Boil test	GG–I–526	GG–I–526	1-forceps	L3*	**
Material	Chemical composition	3.1	GG–I–526	***	--	--

* A minimum of three units shall be tested regardless of lot size.
** Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.
*** See 4.2.3.

4.3 Examination.—The forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.4 Tests.—Tests shall be conducted, as necessary, to determine compliance with specification requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement only, Federal Standard No. 102 should be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing protection for supplies and equipment.

5.1 Packaging and packing.

5.1.1 *Unit of issue.* — One (1) forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 *Packaging quantities.* — The number of units of issue indicated in table II shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

5.1.2.1 *Packing variation permitted.* — If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 *Level A.* — Packaging and packing shall conform to the requirements of Military Specification MIL–P–12902, Procedure Code No. 30.

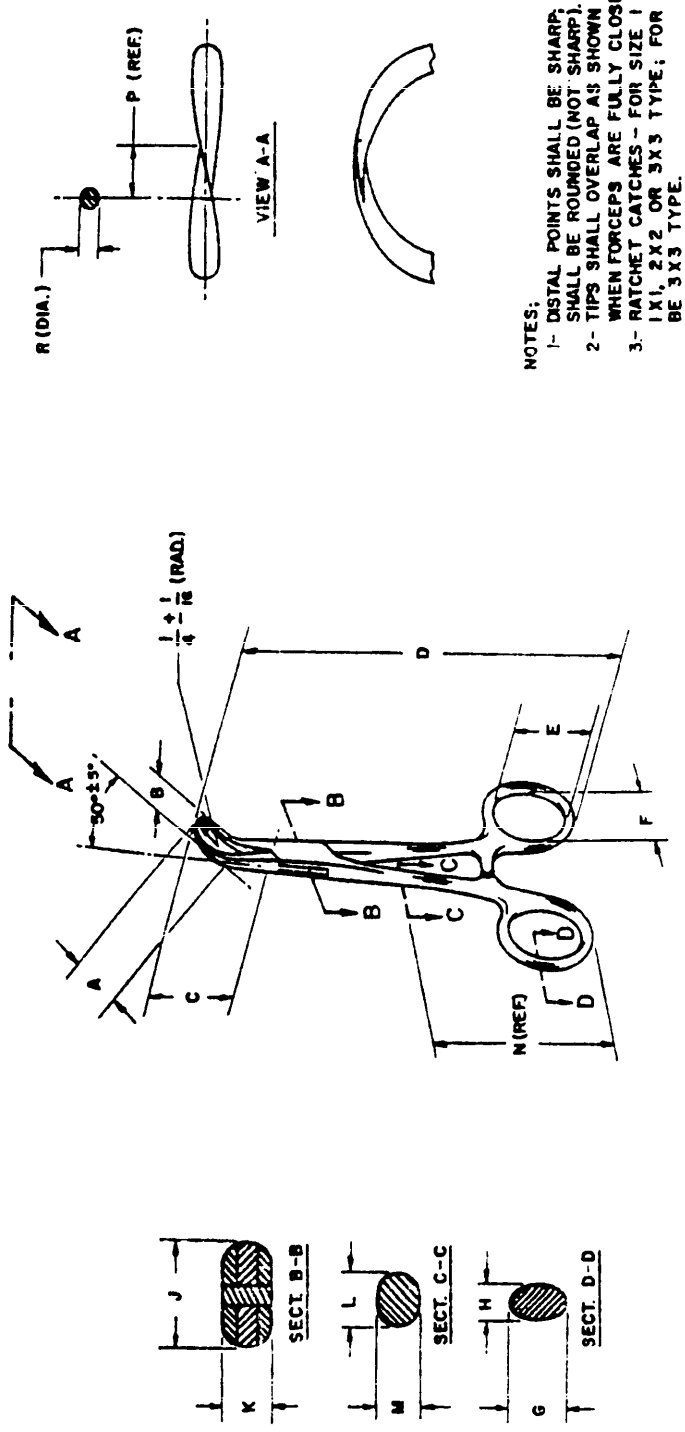
5.1.4 *Level B.* — Packaging and packing shall conform to the requirements of Military Specification MIL–P–12902, Procedure Code No. 20.

5.1.5 *Level C.*—The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used

TABLE II.—*Packaging quantities*

Type	Size	Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
I	1	1 unit	12 units	192 units
I	2	1 unit	12 units	144 units
II	--	1 unit	12 units	144 units

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SIZE	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	J	K	L	M	N	P	R
1	3/8 TO 1/2	7/16 − 1/32	9/16 TO 25/32	3 1/2 − 1/8	7/8 − 1/16	11/16 − 1/16	1/8 − 1/64	3/32 − 1/64	1/4 − 1/32	1/8 − 1/64	3/32 − 1/64	5/64 − 1/64	1/2 (REF.)	1/16 (REF.)	±.008 .030
2	7/16 TO 7/8	19/32 − 1/32	7/8 TO 1 1/16	5 1/4 − 1/4	1 − 1/16	13/16 − 1/16	1/8 − 1/64	3/32 − 1/64	5/16 − 1/32	3/16 − 1/32	1/8 − 1/64	1/8 − 1/64	1 1/4 (REF.)	1/8 (REF.)	±.008 .045

FIGURE 1.—Type 1, Backhaus design.

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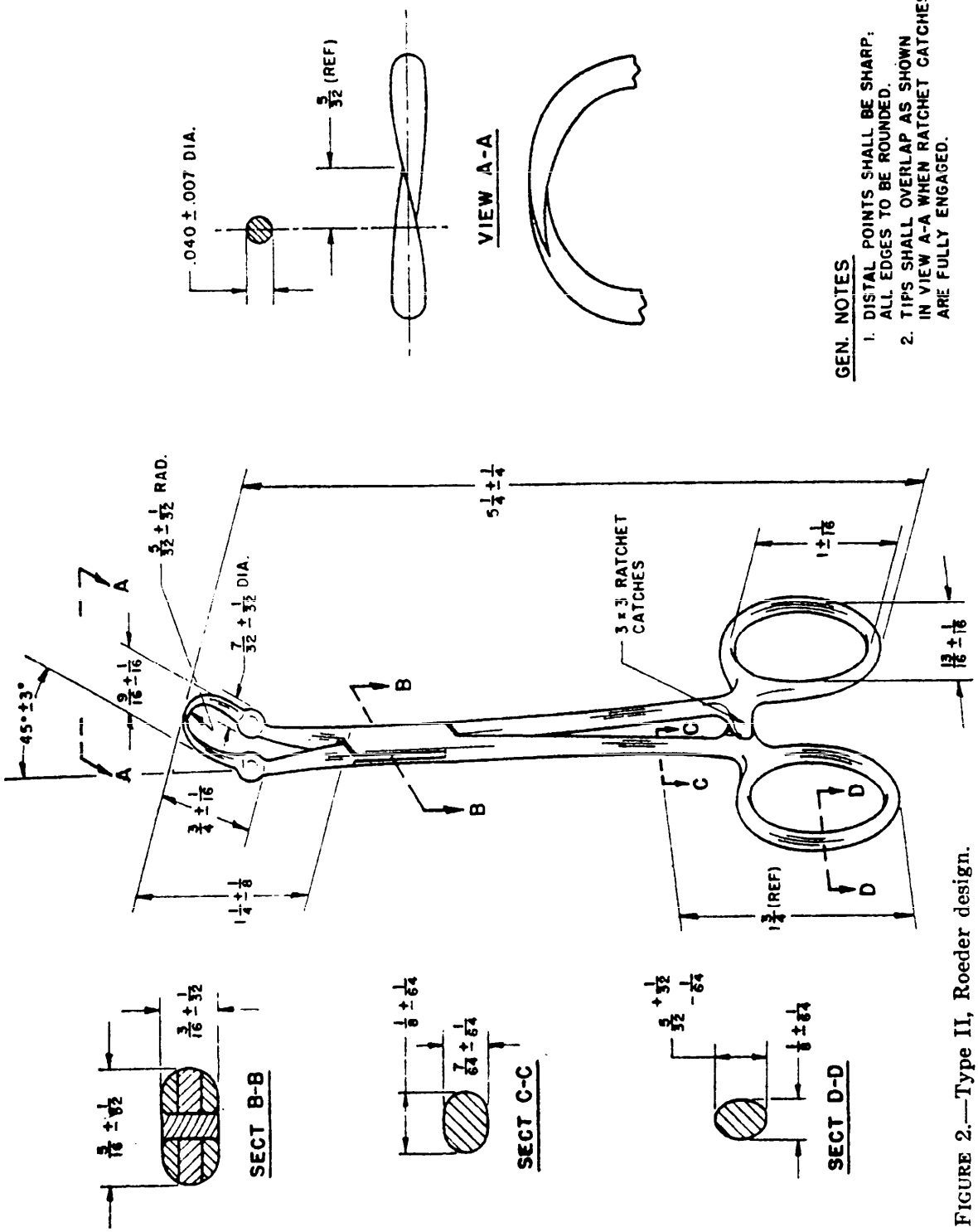


FIGURE 2.—Type II, Roeder design.

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for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.2 **Marking.**

5.2.1 *For nonmilitary agencies.*

5.2.1.1 *Intermediate and exterior containers.* — In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.2.2 *For Military agencies.*

5.2.2.1 *Interior packages.*—Interior packages shall be marked as specified in Military Specification MIL–P–12902, except that the ASMPA stock number shall not be required.

5.2.2.2 *Exterior container.*—Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.**—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Types and sizes required (see 1.2).

(*c*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1).

(1) Level B preservation and packaging is intended to provide economical but limited protection, and should be specified only when it is determined the forceps will be held in covered storage approximately 12 months from date of initial packaging.

6.2 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

6.3 **Transportation description.** — Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Rail:

Surgical Instruments, NOIBN.
Carload minimum weight 10,000 pounds subject to Rule 34 of the Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Surgical instruments, NOI
Truckload minimum weight (w) 10.6 pounds, subject to Rule 34, National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded, by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

CUSTODIANS:
Army—Army Medical Service
Navy—Bureau of Medicine and Surgery
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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